

▲ KADIYAM KAVYA, *41*

| CONGRESS | *Warangal (SC), Telangana*

For the pathologist, politics is in her bloodwork. In November 2023, Kavya quit her government job to campaign for her father, Kadiyam Srihari, a former deputy chief minister in the BRS government. She soon followed his path into politics, and both switched to the Congress in March. Kavya was then nominated from Warangal, a seat her father had won in 2014. After earning her MBBS in 2007 and MD in Pathology in 2013, she worked at a private medical college before joining a government community health centre in 2018. Her husband, Mohammed Nazeerulla Shaik, teaches forensic medicine at a private medical college.





GUMMA THANUJA RANI, *31*

| YSR CONGRESS PARTY | *Araku (ST), Andhra Pradesh*

Thanuja Rani was serving as a medical officer in Alluri Sitharama Raju District Medical and Health Office in Paderu when YSR Congress Party chose her as its candidate from the ST-reserved Araku. Daughter-in-law of former Araku MLA Chetti Palguna, Thanuja Rani's husband Vinay is an active member of the YSRCP too. While father Syam Sunder, on retiring from BSNL, became a village sarpanch, mother Varalakshmi works as a head nurse in Paderu.



RANI SRIKUMAR, *41*

| DMK | *Tenkasi (SC), TN*

An anaesthetist at Sankarankovil Government Hospital, Rani stayed away from active politics even though she has reportedly been a member of the DMK since 2002. In a surprise move, the party nominated her as the candidate over incumbent MP Dhanush M. Kumar. Rani's political ties run deep: husband G. Srikumar, a government contractor, and father Sivakumar, a retired clerk, are also associated with the party. Her uncle P. Durairaj became MLA twice, first representing the DMK and later winning on an AIADMK ticket.



VINOD KUMAR BIND, *50*

| BJP | *Bhadohi, UP*

It was with extreme felicity that the orthopaedic surgeon, who runs a hospital in Chandoli, made his move from the operating theatre to the political theatre. The Samajwadi Party fielded him as its candidate from Gyanpur in the 2022 Uttar Pradesh assembly election but rescinded the decision within two days. Miffed, Bind joined the Nishad Party and won from the Majhawan seat. Cut to 2024, when the BJP chose him to replace incumbent MP Ramesh Chand. Bind won, defeating Lalitesh Tripathi of the Trinamool Congress.



▶ K. SUDHAKAR, *51*

| BJP | *Chikkballapur, Karnataka*

Trained in medicine, Sudhakar came into his own when he switched from the Congress to the BJP in 2019, along with a group of legislators whose defection helped the saffron party come to power in Karnataka that year. But he lost the assembly poll in 2023 from Chikkballapur, a seat he had held for 10 years. The Lok Sabha win now should salvage some of that honour.

▶ RAJEEV BHARADWAJ, *61*

| BJP | *Kangra, Himachal Pradesh*

Few in Himachal anticipated that the dentist would land a BJP ticket. Not only did the party nominate him, but he also achieved a remarkable victory by defeating Congress veteran Anand Sharma by more than 250,000

